



protocols where patient safety, infection control standard and also proactive investment in technology are paramount in providing medical care to patients. We built this hospital to be future ready and future proof that came very handy in monitoring patients remotely, during Covid times.

What are the latest technologies available at MGM Healthcare?

We have some cutting-edge equipment including 3-T SAR MRI, which is high precision and helps in advanced neurological cases, and a 128 slice cardiac CT scan effective in real-time detection of cardiac patients. Other procurements are the state-of-the-art cath lab, both mono-plane and bi-plane, which is used in the event of heart attacks and strokes. We also follow a very stringent angioplasty protocol. These are among the wisest tech investments that really helped in a very short span of time to establish ourselves as the go-to healthcare centre within the heart of the city that caters to the entire Chennai population. I feel proud to say that we are regarded as one of the most sophisticated emergency and critical care response teams in Chennai and the country.

Considering that our population is price sensitive, how feasible has it been for MGM Healthcare to have invested heavily in technology and infrastructure?

To put across the right perspective about the affordability factor in a price sensitive population like India, I want to share that post Covid there has been a phenomenal shift in people's mind set towards the importance of having health insurance. We have witnessed a spurt of almost a good 60 percent having health insurance, a sharp contrast to a meagre 30 percent earlier. This is not only because of increased awareness, but the fact that corporate India has found the key to attract the best talent by ensuring that their near family has health insurance coverage. Therefore, we see a lot of our corporate patients coming in with 100 percent health insurance. Healthcare cost is increasing as it is subject to market inflation and not because doctors and hospitals are getting paid highly. We all are controlled by global market fluctuations that impact costs of the equipment that are imported. We have realised and are now proactive in investing in equipment for minimally invasive surgeries, ensuring rigorous infection control practices and adherence of compliances, enabling us to maintain 99.9 percent infection control rate where the post recovery is faster, and the patient

returns home earlier. It's a win-win situation for all.

How do you envision technology being leveraged in creating a robust national healthcare system where data of patients, irrespective, can be accessed enabling prompt medical attention?

The National Health Mission is working on similar strategy in trying to create a unified healthcare ID data base of patients that has interoperability, which will ensure continuity of care. This comes handy, especially in cases of emergencies or accident traumas, when a patient may not be carrying their medical history with them, so whoever is attending the person can have immediate access to their past medical history. In my opinion, a unified healthcare ID will certainly benefit the healthcare system in India.

Do you maintain a data bank of patients to interact with about the latest MGM Healthcare offerings?

We believe in constant engagement with our patients pre and post op. We maintain patient's data for two reasons. One, because we are mandated to maintain it, but most importantly because sometimes patients are on our follow up, and our post discharge team is constantly in touch with them. We also constantly monitor a patient's health and progress for two reasons – the older patients require reminding and reinforcements so that they continue with their medication, and the other for chronic disease patients.

What differentiates the new MGM Cancer Institute from the rest?

Today, genome sequencing as well as targeted therapy has evolved tremendously. In fact, the same therapy necessarily does not work similarly for two patients with the same cancer, so our aim is to provide personalised cancer care and scale for which we have invested proactively in some cutting-edge technology such as digital PET CT, which is one of its kind in south India that takes half the time, at half the cost, as compared to conventional CT. This will also enable us to screen a lot more patients and since its digital, it's more accurate than the conventional one. We have also invested in a cutting-edge diagnostic centre at

MGM Healthcare, where there will be genome sequencing as well as a lab that will provide stem cell treatment and CAR T Cell treatment, which are very future looking, something that very few centres offer today.

What are your expansion plans for the future, and where do you see MGM Healthcare a decade from now?

MGM Healthcare is a Chennai based brand, so in the immediate future we are looking to expand within the city. Over the next couple of years, we are also hoping to have a pan-south India presence and have various healthcare formats in adjacent markets as well.

Today, as well as in the next 10 years, our only aim is to ensure that every single patient who comes to MGH feels at home with our personalised attention and is reassured, irrespective of the scale, which today may be different from that of tomorrow. We aren't thinking only in terms of numbers of hospitals, but also the net promoter score of each of our patient that we touch.

You can know more about MGM Healthcare, on www.MGMHealthcare.in Or by calling 044 45242407

Dr. Prashanth Rajagopalan,
Director, MGM Healthcare Pvt Ltd

